

Samsung WA5471ABP/XAA

7. Detergent / Washing Problems — Detailed Troubleshooting Manual

This document contains 8 separate troubleshooting topics. Each topic starts on a new page and is written as a sequential procedure. User-level checks are separated from service-level diagnosis.

Model basis: Samsung's WA5471ABP/XAA support page lists the model-specific User Manual (version 4, modified May 3, 2016). The technical information for the WA5471 series documents troubleshooting areas including water valves, inlet screens, hoses, water level sensing, drain/spin, motor, PCB connections, and related service diagnosis. ■cite■turn0search1■turn0search13■

7.1. Detergent remains in dispenser

What this means: Detergent remains in dispenser is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.2. Detergent does not dissolve properly

What this means: Detergent does not dissolve properly is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.3. Excessive detergent

What this means: Excessive detergent is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.4. Excessive suds

What this means: Excessive suds is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.5. Poor cleaning performance

What this means: Poor cleaning performance is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.6. Clothes still dirty after cycle

What this means: Clothes still dirty after cycle is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.7. Detergent/softener buildup in dispenser

What this means: Detergent/softener buildup in dispenser is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.

7.8. Incorrect detergent type

What this means: Incorrect detergent type is treated as the observed symptom or fault condition. Follow the steps in order and stop when the cause is identified.

Step-by-step procedure

Step 1. Stop the cycle and identify whether the problem is caused by detergent quantity, detergent type, dispenser buildup, or washing conditions.

Step 2. Check the detergent package instructions and use only the detergent type and quantity appropriate for the washer and load.

Step 3. Inspect the dispenser. Remove visible residue and clean the accessible dispenser components according to the manual.

Step 4. If excessive suds are present, allow the washer to complete its appropriate suds-management/rinse behavior rather than adding more detergent.

Step 5. For poor cleaning, check load size, cycle selection, water supply, and whether heavily soiled items need pretreatment.

Step 6. Run a suitable rinse or cleaning cycle after correcting the detergent issue and observe whether residue or suds remain.

Step 7. If the problem continues despite correct detergent use and a clean dispenser, investigate water supply, cycle selection, and service-level causes.

When to escalate: If the problem remains after the safe external checks, or if the washer shows repeated electrical, sensor, control, motor, valve, pump, or lock faults, stop user troubleshooting and arrange qualified service.